Digital Literacy Project Report

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Introduction

This project is based on the concept of digital literacy and highlights the role of a Student Digital Ambassador. In today's digital world, it is important for students to understand how to use online platforms effectively, maintain a professional presence, and stay safe from cyber threats. Through this project, I explored different tools and platforms that help in improving digital skills and awareness. The tasks helped me gain practical knowledge about communication, online safety, and professional development.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Infographic

For this task, I created an infographic using Canva. The infographic covered topics such as the meaning of digital literacy, safe internet practices, and maintaining a professional online presence. The aim was to present useful information in a simple and visually appealing way so that students can easily understand it.

While designing the infographic, I found it interesting to use different icons and layouts to represent ideas clearly. However, the main challenge was to include important information without making the design too crowded. This task improved my creativity and ability to present information effectively.

Task 2: Digital Portfolio

In this task, I created my profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. GitHub is a platform where I can upload and manage my coding projects. LinkedIn helps in building a professional network and connecting with industry professionals. Kaggle is useful for learning data science and participating in competitions.

I plan to use these platforms regularly over the next four years by uploading projects, learning new skills, and building my professional profile. These platforms will play an important role in helping me secure internships and job opportunities in the future.

Task 3: Platforms Exploration

For this task, I explored coding and collaboration platforms. I completed a beginner-level problem on HackerRank, which helped me improve my logical thinking and coding skills. It also gave me confidence to solve more problems in the future.

In addition, I created a Google Form quiz related to digital literacy with five questions. I linked the form to Google Sheets to collect and analyze responses. This activity helped me understand how digital tools can be used for collaboration, surveys, and academic purposes. These platforms are very useful for both learning and teamwork.

Task 4: Email Etiquette

This task focused on professional communication through emails. Poorly written emails without proper subject lines, greetings, or structure can lead to misunderstandings and may not be taken seriously.

For example, if a student sends an email to a professor without a clear subject or proper greeting, the message might be ignored or misunderstood. To avoid this, emails should always be polite, clear, and well-structured. Proper email etiquette is important for communicating with professors, recruiters, and professional

□ Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness: Phishing

□ Case Study: Phishing

Phishing is a type of cybercrime where attackers try to trick individuals into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, bank details, or OTPs by pretending to be a trusted entity. It usually happens through emails, SMS messages, or fake websites that look legitimate.

A common example is when a student receives an email that appears to be from their bank or a popular online service. The message may claim that their account has been locked or that urgent verification is required. It contains a link that redirects to a fake website designed to look identical to the original. When the user enters their login credentials or OTP, the attacker captures this information and gains unauthorized access to their account.

Phishing attacks often create a sense of urgency or fear to manipulate users into acting quickly without verifying the source. Students and young users are frequent targets because they may not always recognize such scams.

The consequences of phishing can be serious. Victims may lose money, have their accounts hacked, or face identity theft. In some cases, attackers misuse stolen data for further fraud or illegal activities.

□ Prevention Checklist – Stay Safe Online

- **Do not click on suspicious links in emails or messages**
- **Always check the sender's email address carefully**
- **Verify website URLs before entering login details**
- **Never share OTPs, passwords, or bank details with anyone**
- **Enable two-factor authentication (2FA) on accounts**
- **Avoid using public Wi-Fi for financial transactions**
- **Install antivirus software and keep it updated**
- **Be cautious of messages creating urgency or fear**

UPI / Financial Safety Tips:

- **Never approve unknown payment requests on UPI apps**
- **Double-check recipient details before sending money**

□ Report Cybercrime:

- **National Cyber Crime Portal: https://cybercrime.gov.in**
- **Helpline Number: 1930**

□ Reflection

While researching phishing, I was surprised by how realistic fake emails and websites can appear. Even careful users can sometimes fall victim to these scams if they are not attentive.

This task made me realize the importance of verifying every online interaction, especially when it involves personal or financial information. One habit I will adopt is to always double-check links and avoid responding to suspicious messages immediately. Staying alert and informed is the best way to prevent such cyber threats.

Conclusion

This project helped me understand the importance of digital literacy in today's world. I learned how to use digital platforms responsibly, communicate professionally, and protect myself from cyber threats. These skills will be very useful in my academic journey and future career.

References

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